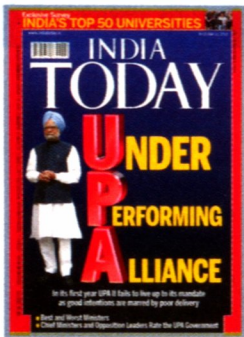


Under Performing Alliance

MAY 31, 2010

The first year of the UPA II is a saga of missed opportunities. Manmohan Singh is the longest serving prime minister in 25 years. Voters expect the man who freed the economy to now liberate India from bureaucratic sloth and get his team to perform.



“The UPA is not just an under performing alliance, but also an under pressure alliance that suffers at the hands of its partners and the likes of Mulayam, Lalu and Mayawati who bailed it out during the cut motions.”

A. SRIKANTAIAH, *Bangalore*

Allied Issues

It's worth remembering that the UPA is still a coalition government ("Under Performing Alliance", May 31). So it has to depend on smaller parties within and outside the alliance. Though the Opposition has been cut to size, it cannot be ignored. Given these limitations, the UPA II has a fair track record though it could have done better. It's time for Prime Minister Manmohan Singh to drop non-performing ministers, at least within the Congress, so that various plans could be implemented better.

DBN MURTHY, *Bangalore*

The UPA Government's performance has had its bright parts, but the overall picture continues to look gloomy. The spec-



Crowned Campuses

It was heartening to see the Banaras Hindu University (BHU) occupying the numero uno position ("Citadels of Learning", May 31). The campus is a beautiful world in itself. Being a part of BHU for six years while pursuing postgraduation and doctoral degrees has certainly made a huge difference to my life. It taught me the skills needed to shape my future and my life.

AMRITA DEB, *Bangalore*

Your ranking of the top universities in the country made for a wonderful reading. The universities must cooperate and coordinate with the corporate world in courses, research and application for the growth, progress and prosperity of the country.

A. JACOB SAHAYAM, *Thiruvananthapuram*

tre of violence unleashed by the Maoists has been a blot on the Government's record, having failed to rein in the extremists or bring them to the negotiating table. The ministers' egos continue to clash and the long list of non-performers in the ministries have been dragging the Government down.

Manmohan Singh looks jaded, helpless and is more of a wimp than a powerful prime minister.

C.V. ARAVIND,

via www.indiatoday.in

It is surprising that two ministers—Mamata Banerjee and M.K. Alagiri—have managed to score 30 and 28 per cent respectively. Both of them deserve a zero for their performance. They are absentee ministers, more interested in becoming

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